

Strategic Organizational Alignment & Management Toolkit

This educational guide reviews the provided templates and frameworks, categorized by their core organizational function. It outlines how these tools benefit business owners and advisors, who they are suited for, and how to deploy them practically.

1. Strategic Feedback Surveys (Client, Supplier, Team)

Overview: This suite of templates provides frameworks for gathering candid feedback from key stakeholders.

- **Benefits:** Utilizes open-ended, conversational questions to bypass "coded language" and polite but unhelpful answers. It actively identifies workflow bottlenecks, internal communication breakdowns, and untapped business opportunities.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Highlights blind spots in service delivery and internal culture, allowing the owner to adapt proactively before clients leave or staff resign.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Yields high-quality, objective data that forms the foundation of a strategic consulting roadmap. It helps advisors pinpoint exactly where a business is leaking value.
- **Suitable For:** Established businesses seeking to benchmark performance, diagnose sudden drops in retention, or improve overall stakeholder engagement.
- **Step-by-step Application:**
 1. **Preparation:** Do not use rigid, lengthy scripts. Focus on securing permission by sounding genuinely interested.
 2. **Engagement:** Call the stakeholder (e.g., "The reason for my call is to see if you'd be open to giving us some honest feedback...").
 3. **Execution:** Ask open-ended questions like, "What are your expectations regarding how we deliver?" or "Where are the workflow bottlenecks?".
 4. **Follow-up:** Show the participant you've acted on their input to build long-term trust.

2. Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) Toolkit

Overview: Includes the "Notice of PIP Meeting," the "PIP Template," and the "Managing Poor Performance" guide.

- **Benefits:** Provides a formal, forward-looking, and legally structured framework to resolve underperformance, distinguishing it from misconduct.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Protects the employer by ensuring fair process (good faith) and clear documentation, mitigating the risk of unfair dismissal or stress-related claims.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Allows the advisor to impartially coach the owner through difficult HR conversations, ensuring emotions are removed and compliance is maintained.
- **Suitable For:** Employers managing staff who fail to meet job standards despite prior informal coaching and support.

- **Step-by-step Application:**
 1. **Notification:** Send the "Notice of PIP Meeting," clearly stating the performance gaps and advising the employee to bring a support person.
 2. **Consultation:** Hold the meeting to discuss concerns and review the draft PIP, allowing the employee to provide feedback.
 3. **Implementation:** Complete the PIP template detailing the performance gap, specific actions required, support/training provided, and the timeline for improvement.
 4. **Review:** Meet at scheduled intervals (e.g., 30, 60, 90 days) to assess milestones and decide if formal warnings are required.

3. Remuneration & Incentive Models

Overview: Features the "Profit Share Agreement," "Incentive Points Explained," and the "Profit Share Model".

- **Benefits:** Aligns employee rewards with business success. The Profit Share model distributes a percentage of surplus funds after attributed costs, while the Points system drives inter-coaching and peer support.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Encourages team members to think laterally about increasing sales or reducing costs. It uses a "wash-up" facility (retaining a percentage of bonuses until year-end) to maintain safe cash flow.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Gives the advisor a tangible tool to mathematically demonstrate the ROI of increased productivity, helping the client transition from fixed-wage mindsets to performance-based cultures.
- **Suitable For:** Businesses with measurable outputs (Points System) or project-based profitability where staff can directly influence margins (Profit Share).
- **Step-by-step Application:**
 1. **Select the Model:** Determine if the team influences margins (Profit Share) or repeatable output (Incentives/Points).
 2. **Define Thresholds & Rules:** Use the Profit Share Model spreadsheet to establish gross margin thresholds and bonus splits.
 3. **Formalize:** Execute the legal Profit Share Agreement, ensuring criteria like a minimum of 12 months' employment are clear.
 4. **Administer:** Track results clearly, deduct appropriate taxes, and hold back "wash-up" funds until the final quarter.

4. Experiential Team Building (Paper & Spaghetti Towers)

Overview: Physical workshop tasks that require teams to build structures using limited resources under time constraints.

- **Benefits:** Acts as a behavioral mirror. It visually demonstrates whether a team is outcome-oriented or process-driven, and highlights how personalities interact under pressure.

- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Flushes out true team dynamics and leadership styles in a low-risk environment, proving that "failing to plan is planning to fail".
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Provides a high-impact workshop exercise. The advisor uses the "Paper Tower Model" spreadsheet to calculate actual profit/loss of the team's effort, driving home the financial impact of poor teamwork.
- **Suitable For:** Team workshops, strategic retreats, or organizations suffering from poor internal communication.
- **Step-by-step Application:**
 1. **Set the Rules:** Issue materials (e.g., 20 sheets of paper, or 20 spaghetti sticks/marshmallow) and state constraints (no prefabrication).
 2. **Plan and Execute:** Give 20 minutes to plan, followed immediately by 10 minutes to build.
 3. **Measure:** Calculate the profit using height achieved minus the cost of materials and time taken.
 4. **Debrief:** Use the "Review Questions" to ask, "Did anybody complete a financial calculation prior to building?" and map the experience to workplace habits.

5. Team Dynamics & Hiring Suite

Overview: Encompasses "Hiring Winners", "Team CANOE Review", and Enneagram Coping materials.

- **Benefits:** Shifts hiring from gut-feeling to an objective assessment of the 'Big Five' traits (Conscientiousness, Agreeableness, Neuroticism, Openness, Extraversion) and maps Enneagram coping styles (Competency, Positive Outlook, Intensity).
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Prevents hiring mistakes by checking if candidates have complementary traits to the existing team, reducing disruptive behaviors.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Allows the advisor to conduct 360-degree audits of the team, mapping out exactly where communication gaps exist and advising on structural reorganization.
- **Suitable For:** Scaling businesses, leaders frustrated with team conflict, or businesses looking to refine their recruitment process.
- **Step-by-step Application:**
 1. **Assess the Current Team:** Have staff complete the 360-degree CANOE review to identify trait gaps.
 2. **Define the Role:** Map the daily tasks to determine if you need a specialist or utility player.
 3. **Grade Applicants:** Use a 3-stage process (Feel, Know, Test) to evaluate candidates, testing them in different environments (e.g., shifting meeting 3 to a cafe).
 4. **Orient:** Pair the new hire with a buddy trained in global and local presentation frameworks.

Common Q&A

Q: How do I choose between a profit-share and a points-based incentive? A: Use profit-sharing when employees can actively influence the sale price or margin (e.g., a sales team). If the team cannot affect profitability but performs highly repeatable tasks, an output-based points program is more effective.

Q: Why should we use the CANOE model instead of standard interviews? A: People often lie or bend their perspectives in standard interviews. CANOE focuses on observable traits rather than temperament. By asking for specific anecdotes (e.g., "Give me an idea of when you last prepared for something you love"), you can test actual behaviors like Conscientiousness.

Q: What makes a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) legally robust? A: It must be an objective, forward-looking process executed in good faith. It requires providing clear expectations, offering practical solutions and training, allowing a realistic timeframe, and distinguishing performance gaps from disciplinary misconduct.

Q: How do I ensure I get honest responses from the Client or Supplier Surveys? A: Avoid long, scripted checklists. Focus on building the relationship eyeball-to-eyeball or over the phone. You must establish permission, keep questions open-ended, and actively demonstrate later that you have acted on their input.

Q: Why use experiential tasks like the Paper Tower? A: These tasks force teams out of their standard workflow and expose natural dynamics. It allows facilitators to observe if the team appointed a timekeeper, accurately defined the objective, or assessed options without bias, providing a mirror to how they operate daily.

Q: How do I manage an employee whose poor performance is linked to a "Disruptive" Enneagram type? A: Identify their coping style. For example, if they are a 'Challenger' (Type 8), they cope with intensity. Manage them by matching their energy but staying focused on the issue, not the person, and avoiding telling them to "calm down".

Source Material Summary

Template Name	Core Focus & Contents
Business Clock vs Body Clock	Explores efficiency vs. effectiveness, advising on how to align work productivity with natural circadian and circaseptan biological rhythms to prevent burnout.

Cafe Behaviours	Turnaround	Provides structural considerations and specific up-sell scripts for staff based on customer engagement levels and queue lengths.
Client Survey		A guide and script for conducting conversational surveys to gather honest feedback on service delivery and internal communications.
Coping with Covid:		Explains the three Enneagram Harmonic Coping Styles (Intensity, Competency, Positive Outlook) used to defend against loss and disappointment.
Coping with the types at their worst.		Details the 9 Enneagram personality types, identifying their disruptive behaviors in business and specific strategies for coping with them.
EF.Incentive Explained	Points	Outlines a team-based points reward program, detailing how points are earned via sales, penalization rules, and prize redemption.
EF.Profit Share Agreement		A formal legal contract outlining the terms for distributing a bonus pool based on project profitability, attributed costs, and wash-up clauses.
GE.SMART & FAST Goals		A presentation on formulating goals using the SMART method, heavily emphasizing the 'Affect' component and mental visualization.
Hiring Winners		Strategies for assessing leadership styles, testing CANOE traits, remaining legally compliant, and using a 3-stage applicant grading system.

L.Supt.Alignment		Connects Maslow's and Alderfer's theories to the 5 content domains (Being, Knowing, Relating, Having, Doing) to craft Vision, Purpose, and Strategy statements.
Leadership Review:		A self-assessment questionnaire for leaders to evaluate their culture of creativity vs. discipline, inclusivity, and conflict resolution.
Managing Performance	Poor	Government-based guidelines differentiating poor performance from misconduct, detailing PIP requirements, and handling stress/bullying claims.
Notice of PIP Meeting.		A formal letter template inviting an employee to discuss underperformance and proposing a structured Performance Improvement Plan.
PIP Template		A structural form for documenting performance gaps, employer expectations, required actions, provided support, and scheduled review dates.
Paper Tower Model		A calculation spreadsheet determining the profit or loss of the paper tower exercise based on materials drawn, height, and time.
Paper Tower Review Questions		A debrief guide for the experiential exercise, emphasizing the 9-step planning process and evaluating team dynamics.
Paper Tower Task Sheet		Instructions and constraints for building a self-supporting tower using 500 sheets of paper within strict time limits.

Productive Habits (Slides)	Explains the progressive learning path (Acquiring to Mastery) and introduces a 5-step framework for building replacement habits.
Productive Habits (Doc)	A simple matrix tracking a reason, trigger, micro-habit, effective practice, and long-term plan for behavioral change.
Profit Share Model	A comprehensive spreadsheet calculating gross margin thresholds, bonus splits, and quarterly wash-up distributions for team members.
Remuneration & Incentives	Guidelines on matching remuneration options (Equity, Bonus, Time in Lieu) to desired behavioral outcomes and business profitability.
Spaghetti Tower Task Sheet	Instructions and constraints for an experiential team-building exercise using spaghetti, tape, string, and a marshmallow.
Supplier Survey	A conversational survey framework designed to uncover communication gaps and untapped product/training opportunities with vendors.
Team 'CANOE' Review	A spreadsheet matrix used to collate and average 360-degree feedback from team members assessing the Big Five personality traits.
Team Survey	A brief internal questionnaire asking employees about role clarity, workflow bottlenecks, management feedback, and delegation opportunities.

Team Workshop Run Sheet A minute-by-minute schedule template for facilitating a comprehensive two-day team building and strategic alignment workshop.

AI Branch Chain Logic Table

Logic Branch	IF (Condition / Trigger)	THEN (Action / Next Step)	Additional Context / Notes
Branch 1: Hiring & Scaling	IF the client states, "We can't seem to find the right people" or "Our new hires keep clashing with the team"...	THEN deploy the Hiring Winners presentation to assess role requirements, followed by the Team 'CANOE' Review .	Ensure the client understands the difference between hiring for skill and assessing observable traits. Focus on balancing team dynamics rather than hiring 'clones'.
Branch 2: HR & Underperformance	IF the client states, "My staff are constantly making errors and not following procedures"...	THEN introduce the Managing Poor Performance guide, followed by the Notice of PIP Meeting and PIP Template .	Ascertain if the issue is a genuine skill/training gap (Performance) or a behavioral attitude issue (Misconduct), as the legal processes differ.

Branch 3: Motivation & Stagnation	IF the client states, "The team lacks drive and just does the bare minimum"...	THEN review the Remuneration & Incentives guidelines, followed by the Profit Share Model or EF.Incentive Points .	Determine if the staff have the autonomy to influence profit margins (use Profit Share) or if they strictly execute repeatable output (use Points).
Branch 4: Team Friction & Conflict	IF the client states, "There is too much office politics and people aren't working together"...	THEN facilitate the Paper Tower Task , followed by evaluating behaviors using Coping with the types at their worst .	The physical task flushes out natural behaviors under pressure. Use the Enneagram guide to teach the manager how different staff respond to adversity.
Branch 5: Strategic Alignment	IF the client states, "Everyone is working in silos and we've lost our overall direction"...	THEN schedule a 2-day session using the Team Workshop Run Sheet and the L.Suppt.Alignment module.	Focus the workshop on clarifying the 5 Domains (Vision, Purpose, Values, Mission, Strategy) so the team understands the "Why" and "How".